

Support for infra-red blasters

Android KitKat supports in-built IR blasters and also exposes new APIs and systems services that let applications leverage this feature. This means depending on device support for IR functionality, which can be used to control a variety of devices including TV, stereo, etc.

New applications

Some of the additional apps include Drive (for file storage), Quick Office (for text documents), and Keep (for note taking) including apps for presentations and spreadsheets. QuickOffice is Google's own office application that allows the user to create and edit Microsoft Office documents, spreadsheets and presentations. People will be able to sync their documents in Google Drive with their cloud-stored files. Quick Office lets people save their images as PDF files locally or view network printers and print out a hard copy. Here, you also have options for paper size, colour or black-and-white, the numbers of pages to print, orientation, etc. Google apps like the Chrome browser, Currents, G+ Photos, Google+ and Maps are included in the firmware.

The Google Keyboard 2.0 is another app that has the on-press effect and pop-up keys turned to gray. Jelly Bean's ASCII-style Remote key has been replaced with a full emoji

'keyboard'. It is also available on the Play store for older versions. The clock app is modified to give a new look to the UI and quick access to the alarm feature with just a single left swipe, a function that was not that user-friendly in Jelly Bean.

The email app has got completely revamped and now features cutting edge features just like in the case of the Gmail app. The email app combined with Quick Office and Keep is sure to increase Android usage in the enterprise world.

Overall, KitKat may appear to have only subtle user experience improvements but along with exciting new features and some more Google productivity apps, users now have a faster, smoother and much more polished interface. From the enterprise perspective, Android KitKat's enhancements make it the better choice. People are now waiting for KitKat updates on existing device models other than Google Nexus. **END** 

By Pooja Maheshwari

The author is a technical architect at Impetus Technologies. She has been working in the software domain for more than 12 years, with wide exposure in analysis, design and the development of enterprise mobility solutions, mobile device management solutions and Android-based custom device solutions for enterprises. She is currently involved in the challenges and opportunities linked to the applicability of embedded Android for enterprises in various verticals. She can be reached at pooja.a.maheshwari@gmail.com

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